

Conflict of Interest Policy

Keeping decisions clean, and visibly so

Policy owner	CHIEF OPERATIONS OFFICER	Approved by	Board of Trustees
Version	1.0	Date adopted	05/08/2026
Applies to	All trustees, advisers to the Board, staff, volunteers and consultants involved in any decision on spending, selection, recruitment or partnership		
Register held by	COO — reviewed by the Board annually		

1. Purpose

- 1.1 A conflict of interest is not wrongdoing. It arises naturally in a small, community-rooted organisation. What matters is that it is **declared, recorded and managed** before it affects a decision.
- 1.2 This policy exists so that decisions of the Foundation are made, and can be seen to be made, solely in the interests of the people we serve.

2. Definitions

- 2.1 An **actual conflict** exists where a person's private interest does influence, or stands to benefit from, a decision they take part in.
- 2.2 A **potential conflict** exists where such an interest could arise in future.
- 2.3 A **perceived conflict** exists where a reasonable outsider might believe a private interest could influence a decision. **Perceived conflicts must be declared and managed in the same way as actual ones**, because credibility is damaged by appearance as much as by fact.
- 2.4 **Connected person** includes a spouse or partner, child, parent, sibling, other close relative or household member, close personal friend, business partner, and any organisation in which the person or a connected person holds a position, ownership or material interest.

3. Circumstances requiring declaration

SITUATION	EXAMPLES RELEVANT TO THE FOUNDATION
Governance	Holding both a governance and an executive role; a family relationship between a Trustee and a member of staff
Procurement	A supplier, contractor, landlord, carpenter or media agency owned or employed by a Trustee, a member of staff, or a connected person
Beneficiary selection	A relative, neighbour, friend or connected person being considered for a scholarship, grant, shelter support or place on any programme
Recruitment	A connected person applying for a paid or volunteer role
Partnership	A partner organisation in which a Trustee, adviser or staff member holds a position or interest
External interests	Other directorships, trusteeships, consultancies or employment that could compete with the Foundation's interests or claim on a person's time
Gifts	Any gift or hospitality declarable under the Anti-Fraud Policy

4. Duty to declare

- 4.1 Everyone covered by this policy completes a written declaration of interests **on appointment and annually thereafter**, using the form at Annex A.
- 4.2 A new or changed interest must be declared **as soon as it arises**, and in any event before the relevant decision is taken.
- 4.3 Every Board and committee meeting opens with an invitation to declare interests in the business before it. Declarations are minuted.
- 4.4 Where a person is unsure whether an interest is declarable, they must declare it. **The test is not whether it feels significant, but whether an outsider might think it relevant.**

5. Managing a declared conflict

- 5.1 The person with the interest **withdraws from the discussion and from the decision**. They do not vote, are not counted in the quorum for that item, and normally leave the room.
- 5.2 They may be asked to provide factual information before withdrawing, and must not seek to influence the decision informally, before or afterwards.
- 5.3 The declaration, the withdrawal and the decision reached are recorded in the minutes.
- 5.4 Where a conflict is persistent rather than occasional, the Board considers whether the person should stand down from the relevant role.

6. Related party transactions

- 6.1** The Foundation may contract with a connected person or connected organisation **only** where: the interest has been declared; the person has withdrawn from the decision; an open process has demonstrated value for money; and the Board has approved the transaction in advance.
- 6.2** All such transactions are recorded in the register and disclosed in the Foundation's annual accounts.
- 6.3** No Trustee may receive payment for serving as a Trustee. Payment for goods or services supplied in another capacity is permitted only under clause 6.1.

7. Governance concentration

- 7.1** The Board recognises that the Foundation's Founder also chairs the Board, and that this concentration is itself a structural conflict requiring active management.
- 7.2** Accordingly: decisions concerning the Founder-Chair's own role, remuneration, related interests or conduct are taken in her absence and chaired by another Trustee; and the Board has committed to appointing independent Trustees and to a transition to an independent Chair.

8. The register

- 8.1** A Register of Interests is maintained recording each person's declared interests, the date declared, and how any conflict was managed.
- 8.2** The register is reviewed by the Board annually and is available to the Foundation's auditors and, on request, to funders.

9. Breach

- 9.1** Failure to declare an interest, or participating in a decision from which one should have withdrawn, is a disciplinary matter and may result in removal from office, dismissal or termination of contract.

ANNEX A — DECLARATION OF INTERESTS

I declare the interests set out below. I undertake to declare any new or changed interest as soon as it arises, and to withdraw from any decision in which I have an interest.

Full name

Role in the Foundation

NATURE OF INTEREST

ORGANISATION OR PERSON CONCERNED

RELATIONSHIP

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If you have no interests to declare, write "None" above and sign below.

Signature

Date

Received by (register holder)